breaking point, spilling over into the political sphere and causing further strain. By not standing up to Chinese intimidation now, the costs of doing so later on will certainly be much higher.

All of this bodes ill for the future. The world will have to deal with a far stronger and more aggressive China that appears bent on undermining or ignoring global norms of conduct, even as it continues to nurture a sense of grievance that foreign nations are scheming against it. At home, trade with the West has enriched a Communist leadership that is intent on further subjugating its people and serving as a model of illiberal rule. Abroad, instead of building bonds of trust with its neighbors and major partners, Beijing bullies and regularly steals from them, while proclaiming its innocence and asserting that it, too, is a victim. The West should have known there was a downside to the bet it made on China nearly a half century ago. How well the world deals with the new China rules may in part determine the global balance of power over the next generation.

Notes

1. "China Has Forced a Pacific Airline to Close Down Because of Diplomatic Ties with Taiwan," *Business Insider*, July 18, 2018, https://www.businessinsider.com/palau-airline-closes-over-anger-from-china-about-taiwan-ties-2018-7.
2. Sul-Lee Wee, "Giving In to China, U.S. Airlines Drop Taiwan (in Name at Least)," *New York Times*, July 25, 2018, https://www.nytimes.com/2018/07/25/business/taiwan-american-airlines-china.html.
3. James Kitfield, "Admiral Davidson: China Assaults International Order," *Breaking Defense*, July 18, 2019, https://breakingdefense.com/2019/07/adm-davidson-china-assaults-international-order.
4. Toasts of Richard Nixon and Zhou Enlai, February 21, 1972, available at http://www.presidency.ucsb.edu/ws/?pid=3748. For an overview of Washington's China policy from the 1970s through the 1990s, see James Mann, *About Face: A History of America's Curious Relationship with China, from Nixon to Clinton* (New York: Vintage, 2000).